

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ Q

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6

♥ 9

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 5

♥ J 10 6 5 3 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ A

♠ K 9 2

♥ A K 8 7 4

♦ K 10 7

♣ 10 8

West

North

East

South

Dbl

2♣¹

1♥

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

Lead: ♦Q

South opens 1♥ and West Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2♣ without fear that South will think you have a strong hand. South also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ A 10 6 5 3
 ♦ 10 5 4
 ♣ 10 9 5 4

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ K 7 3

♣ -



♠ 10 3
 ♥ 9 8 4
 ♦ A 9
 ♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

Lead: ♦ A

wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. South responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. South agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). South bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

South's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. North realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that North did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces, South would have shown one Ace and North

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 10 9
♣ 8 6 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ K J 9



♠ K 5 3

♥ 10 5

♦ 8 6 5 4

♣ A Q 7 3

♠ A J 10 8 2

♥ A K 8 2

♦ Q 2

♣ 10 5

South opens 1♠. You respond 2♦, a 2/1 force to game. Partner rebids 2♥, showing a 4-card side suit.

You don't have 4♥s, nor do you have 3♠s. You do, however, have stoppers in ♣s so you bid 2NT. South happily says 3NT.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
Lead: ♥10			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 5
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ 6 5 4
 ♣ Q J 8 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ K Q 3

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ 10 9 7



♠ K Q 9 3

♥ J 7 4

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A 6 3

♠ A J 10 8 2

♥ A 10 8 2

♦ Q 2

♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
Lead: ♦ 6			

South opens 1 ♠. How do you respond? You bid 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. South rebids 2 ♥, showing a 4-card heart suit.

You don't have 4 ♥s, nor do you have 3 ♠s.

Furthermore, you don't have stoppers in ♣s so you cannot bid NT. Since you have to keep bidding, but have no reasonable bid you can make, you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♣.

Compare this Deal with Deal 21.

South understands that North's ♣ bid is Fourth-Suit-Forcing, and does not actually show ♣s. However since South does have a ♣ stopper he bids 3NT. In this case this turns out to be the best game contract.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J
♥ J 10 8 7 4
♦ J 10 6
♣ K J 2

♠ A K 9 7 4

♥ K Q 6 3

♦ 7 3

♣ 10 7



♠ 6 5 3

♥ 9 5

♦ K Q 9

♣ A 9 6 4 3

♠ 10 8 2

♥ A 2

♦ A 8 5 4 2

♣ Q 8 5

South passes - what should you open? South now bids 2♦. Since South originally passed this is **NOT** 2/1 Game Force. Instead, it is non-forcing and shows 11 or more points. You should show your 4-card ♥ suit. South gives a preference to 2♠. What do you do now?

Knowing that South does not have opening strength you pass 2♠.

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
All Pass			
Lead: ♠3			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 5
 ♥ 5 2
 ♦ K Q 10 9 5 3
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ 9 8 6 3

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ K Q 3



♠ A J 9 3
 ♥ K Q J 10
 ♦ J
 ♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K Q 10 6 2

♥ A 7 4

♦ 8 4

♣ A 8 5

South opens 1♠. With 9 points and a doubleton ♠ you must respond 1NT. Partner rebids 2♣.

North prefers ♣ over ♠ but must allow for the possibility that South has bid a 3-card suit. So North gives a preference to 2♠. This is called a "false preference", but it assures the team of being in at least a 7-card fit. South happily passes and the pair lands in a reasonable contract, probably better than 1NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
Lead: ♥5			